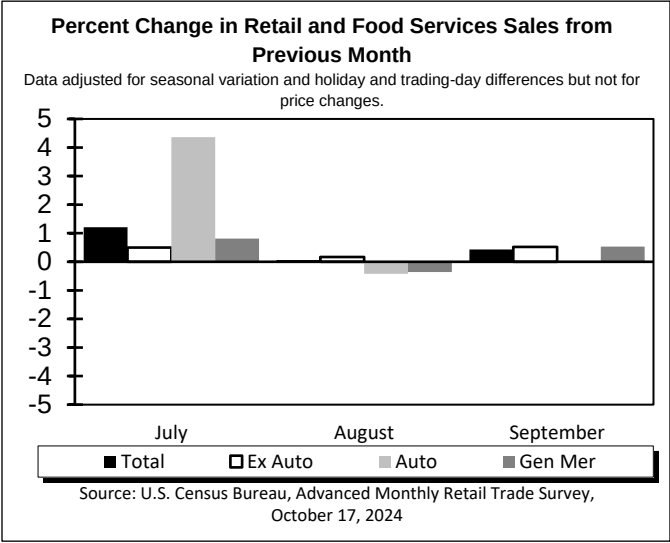


ADVANCE MONTHLY SALES FOR RETAIL AND FOOD SERVICES, SEPTEMBER 2024

Release Number: CB24-166

October 17, 2024 — The U.S. Census Bureau announced the following advance estimates of U.S. retail and food services sales for September 2024:

ADVANCE MONTHLY SALES		
September 2024	\$714.4 billion	0.4%*
August 2024 (revised)	\$711.3 billion	0.1%*
Next release: November 15, 2024		
* The 90 percent confidence interval includes zero. There is insufficient statistical evidence to conclude that the actual change is different from zero. Data adjusted for seasonal variation and holiday and trading-day differences but not for price changes. Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Advanced Monthly Retail Trade Survey, October 17, 2024		



Advance Estimates of U.S. Retail and Food Services

Advance estimates of U.S. retail and food services sales for September 2024, adjusted for seasonal variation and holiday and trading-day differences, but not for price changes, were \$714.4 billion, an increase of 0.4 percent (± 0.5 percent)* from the previous month, and up 1.7 percent (± 0.5 percent) from September 2023. Total sales for the July 2024 through September 2024 period were up 2.3 percent (± 0.5 percent) from the same period a year ago. The July 2024 to August 2024 percent change was unrevised from up 0.1 percent (± 0.2 percent)*.

Retail trade sales were up 0.3 percent (± 0.5 percent)* from August 2024, and up 1.4 percent (± 0.5 percent) from last year. Nonstore retailers were up 7.1 percent (± 1.4 percent) from last year, while food services and drinking places were up 3.7 percent (± 2.1 percent) from September 2023.

General Information

The October 2024 Advance Monthly Retail report is scheduled for release on November 15, 2024 at 8:30 a.m. EST. View the full schedule in the Economic Briefing Room: <<https://www.census.gov/economic-indicators/>>. The full text and tables of this release can be found at <www.census.gov/retail/>.

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EXPLANATORY NOTES

The advance estimates are based on a subsample of the Census Bureau's full retail and food services sample. A stratified random sampling method is used to select approximately 4,800 retail and food services firms whose sales are then weighted and benchmarked to represent the complete universe of over three million retail and food services firms. For more information on how data is collected for the Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, see our methodology page at:

https://www.census.gov/retail/marts/how_surveys_are_collected.html.

Survey Description

The U.S. Census Bureau conducts the Advance Monthly Retail Trade and Food Services Survey to provide an early estimate of monthly sales by kind of business for retail and food service firms located in the United States. Each month, questionnaires are mailed to a probability sample of approximately 4,800 employer firms selected from the larger Monthly Retail Trade Survey. Advance sales estimates are computed using a link relative estimator. For each detailed industry, we compute a ratio of current-to-previous month weighted sales using data from units for which we have obtained usable responses for both the current and previous month. For each detailed industry, the advance total sales estimates for the current month is computed by multiplying this ratio by the preliminary sales estimate for the previous month (derived from the larger MRTS) at the appropriate industry level. Total estimates for broader industries are computed as the sum of the detailed industry estimates. The link relative estimate is used because imputation is not performed for most nonrespondents in MARTS. For a limited number of nonresponding companies that have influential effects on the estimates, sales may be estimated based on historical performance of that company. The monthly estimates are benchmarked to the annual survey estimates from the Annual Retail Trade Survey once available. The estimates are adjusted for seasonal variation and holiday and trading day differences. Additional information on MARTS and MRTS can be found on the Census Bureau website at: www.census.gov/retail.

The Census Bureau has reviewed this data product to ensure appropriate access, use, and disclosure avoidance protection of the confidential source data (Project No. P-7504206, Disclosure Review Board (DRB) approval number: CBDRB-FY25-0002).

Reliability of Estimates

Because the estimates presented in this report are based on a sample survey, they contain sampling error and nonsampling error.

Sampling error is the difference between the estimate and the result that would be obtained from a complete enumeration of the sampling frame conducted under the same survey conditions. This error

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occurs because only a subset of the entire sampling frame is measured in a sample survey. Standard errors and coefficients of variation (CV), as given in Table 3 of this report, are estimated measures of sampling variation.

The margin of sampling error, as used on page 1, gives a range about the estimate which is a 90 percent confidence interval. If, for example, the percent change estimate is +1.2 percent and its estimated standard error is 0.9 percent, then the margin of sampling error is $\pm 1.753 \times 0.9$ percent or ± 1.6 percent, and the 90 percent confidence interval is -0.4 percent to +2.8 percent. If the interval contains 0, then one does not have sufficient evidence to conclude at the 90 percent confidence level that the change is different from zero and therefore the change is not statistically significant. Estimated changes shown in the text are statistically significant unless otherwise noted. For a monthly total, the median estimated coefficient of variation is given. The resulting confidence interval is the estimated value $\pm 1.753 \times CV \times$ (the estimated monthly total). The Census Bureau recommends that individuals using estimates in this report incorporate this information into their analyses, as sampling error could affect the conclusions drawn from the estimates.

Nonsampling error encompasses all other factors that contribute to the total error of a sample survey estimate. This type of error can occur because of nonresponse, insufficient coverage of the universe of retail businesses, mistakes in the recording and coding of data, and other errors of collection, response, coverage, or processing. Although nonsampling error is not measured directly, the Census Bureau employs quality control procedures throughout the process to minimize this type of error.

Weather Information

For information on the impact of weather events on the compilation of this report, please see the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) on our website at:

<www.census.gov/retail/marts_weather_faq.html>

RESOURCES

The Rest of the Consumer Spending Story

Retail and services together represent what's commonly referred to as consumer spending. Quarterly Services Survey (QSS) revenue comprises roughly 2/3 of the personal consumption expenditures component of the U.S. Gross Domestic Product (GDP) measured by the Bureau of Economic Analysis (BEA). The second quarter 2024 Quarterly Services Report was released on August 19, 2024 at 10:00 AM. Learn about historical revenue trends for certain industries going back 15 years and other data, such as in-patient days and discharges for hospitals, by visiting <<https://www.census.gov/services/index.html>>

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API

The Census Bureau's application programming interface lets developers create custom apps to reach new users and makes key demographic, socio-economic and housing statistics more accessible than ever before. <www.census.gov/developers/>

FRED Mobile App



Receive the latest updates on the nation's key economic indicators by downloading the FRED App <<https://fred.stlouisfed.org/fred-mobile/>> for both Apple and Android devices. FRED, the signature database of the Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis, now incorporates the Census Bureau's 13 economic indicators.

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* The 90 percent confidence interval includes zero. There is insufficient statistical evidence to conclude that the actual change is different from zero.

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Table 1. Estimated Monthly Sales for Retail and Food Services, by Kind of Business

(Total sales estimates are shown in millions of dollars and are based on data from the Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, Monthly Retail Trade Survey, and administrative records.)

NAICS ¹ code	Kind of Business	Not Adjusted							Adjusted ²				
		9 Month Total		2024			2023		2024			2023	
		2024	% Chg. 2023	Sep. ³ (a)	Aug. (p)	Jul. (r)	Sep.	Aug.	Sep. ³ (a)	Aug. (p)	Jul. (r)	Sep. (r)	Aug. (r)
	Retail & food services,												
	total	6,280,491	2.6	681,456	736,722	726,098	681,679	718,533	714,358	711,291	710,851	702,160	696,238
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts) ...	5,069,548	3.0	553,310	593,249	585,742	548,817	577,027	580,504	577,492	576,484	567,935	563,381
	Total (excl. gasoline stations)	5,800,197	3.0	630,230	679,804	668,631	623,885	658,027	663,234	659,311	658,226	644,882	640,626
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts & gasoline stations)	4,589,254	3.6	502,084	536,331	528,275	491,023	516,521	529,380	525,512	523,859	510,657	507,769
	Retail	5,425,051	2.2	587,755	636,934	629,309	589,258	624,457	617,958	615,891	615,960	609,181	604,187
	GAFO⁴	(*)	(*)	(*)	137,390	129,958	123,919	133,614	(*)	131,254	131,839	129,690	129,850
441	Motor vehicle & parts dealers	1,210,943	0.9	128,146	143,473	140,356	132,862	141,506	133,854	133,799	134,367	134,225	132,857
4411, 4412	Auto & other motor veh. dealers .	1,106,797	0.6	116,688	131,113	128,325	121,541	129,346	122,186	122,193	122,799	122,893	121,566
44111	New car dealers	(*)	(*)	(*)	108,581	105,392	99,898	105,573	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)
4413	Auto parts, acc. & tire stores.....	(*)	(*)	(*)	12,360	12,031	11,321	12,160	(*)	11,606	11,568	11,332	11,291
442	Furniture & home furn. stores	98,511	-5.1	10,859	11,972	11,391	11,462	11,906	11,058	11,220	11,267	11,315	11,264
4421	Furniture stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	6,341	6,157	6,474	6,528	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)
4422	Home furnishings stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)
443	Electronics & appliance stores	66,052	0.6	7,036	7,789	7,659	7,533	7,685	7,446	7,697	7,831	7,806	7,647
444	Building material & garden eq. & supplies dealers.....	369,341	-2.0	39,914	42,914	44,088	39,883	43,921	41,242	41,150	41,153	41,018	41,205
4441	Building mat. & sup. dealers	(*)	(*)	(*)	38,238	39,157	34,782	38,698	(*)	36,006	35,957	35,312	35,601
445	Food & beverage stores.....	739,245	2.0	81,176	85,238	85,233	80,681	82,889	84,062	83,270	83,658	81,986	81,920
4451	Grocery stores	663,885	1.8	72,978	76,337	76,240	72,346	74,491	75,313	74,548	74,892	73,448	73,463
4453	Beer, wine & liquor stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	6,319	6,375	5,894	5,947	(*)	6,111	6,153	6,014	5,953
446	Health & personal care stores	328,383	2.8	37,282	38,160	37,342	35,946	37,069	38,238	37,820	37,605	36,568	36,593
44611	Pharmacies & drug stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	31,978	31,642	30,101	31,033	(*)	31,693	31,485	30,622	30,514
447	Gasoline stations	480,294	-2.4	51,226	56,918	57,467	57,794	60,506	51,124	51,980	52,625	57,278	55,612
448	Clothing & clothing accessories stores	218,987	2.4	23,405	27,274	25,453	23,332	26,657	26,472	26,076	26,299	25,579	25,922
44811	Men's clothing stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(*)	(S)	(S)	(S)	(S)
44812	Women's clothing stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	3,060	2,932	2,959	3,055	(*)	3,066	3,038	3,135	3,121
44814	Family clothing stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	11,830	11,085	9,739	11,072	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)	(NA)
4482	Shoe stores	(*)	(*)	(*)	4,112	3,462	3,078	4,280	(*)	3,166	3,310	3,335	3,365
451	Sporting goods, hobby, musical instrument, & book stores	69,986	-3.9	7,636	8,878	7,998	8,209	9,194	8,167	8,145	8,136	8,463	8,489
452	General merchandise stores.....	657,490	2.8	71,158	78,584	74,852	70,746	75,414	75,992	75,589	75,860	74,091	74,121
4521	Department stores	92,083	-1.4	9,869	11,398	10,440	10,112	11,455	10,882	10,841	10,955	11,017	11,071
4529	Other general merch. stores.....	(*)	(*)	(*)	67,186	64,412	60,634	63,959	(*)	64,748	64,905	63,074	63,050
45291	Warehouse clubs & supercenters.....	(*)	(*)	(*)	58,184	55,711	52,218	55,327	(*)	55,572	55,823	54,168	54,242
45299	All oth. gen. merch. stores.....	(*)	(*)	(*)	9,002	8,701	8,416	8,632	(*)	9,176	9,082	8,906	8,808
453	Miscellaneous store retailers	135,773	6.2	15,527	15,669	15,482	14,548	14,452	15,755	15,147	15,107	14,606	13,883
454	Nonstore retailers	1,050,046	8.2	114,390	120,065	121,988	106,262	113,258	124,548	123,998	122,052	116,246	114,674
4541	Elect. shopping & m/o houses	(*)	(*)	(*)	112,283	113,927	97,306	103,679	(*)	115,517	113,135	106,113	104,515
722	Food services & drinking places	855,440	5.0	93,701	99,788	96,789	92,421	94,076	96,400	95,400	94,891	92,979	92,051

(*) Advance estimates are not available for this kind of business.

(NA) Not available (a) Advance estimate (p) Preliminary estimate (r) Revised estimate

(S) Estimate does not meet publication standards because of high sampling variability (coefficient of variation is greater than 30%), poor response quality (total quantity response rate is less than 50%), or other concerns about the estimate's quality.

(1) For a full description of the NAICS codes used in this table, see <<https://www.census.gov/naics/>>.

(2) Estimates are concurrently adjusted for seasonal variation and for holiday and trading day differences, but not for price changes. Concurrent seasonal adjustment uses all available unadjusted estimates as input to the X-13ARIMA-SEATS program. The factors derived from the program are used in calculating all seasonally adjusted estimates shown in this table. Year-to-date seasonally adjusted sales estimates are not tabulated. Adjustment factors and explanatory material can be found on the Internet at <<http://www.census.gov/retail/>>.

(3) Advance estimates are based on early reports obtained from a small sample of firms selected from the larger Monthly Retail Trade Survey (MRTS) sample. All other estimates are from the MRTS sample.

(4) GAFO represents firms that specialize in department store types of merchandise and is comprised of furniture & home furnishings (442), electronics & appliances (443), clothing & accessories (448), sporting goods, hobby, musical instrument, and book (451), general merchandise (452), office supply, stationery, and gift stores (4532).

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, October 17, 2024. (Project No. P-7504206 / Approval CBDRB-FY25-0002), Table 3 provides estimated measures of sampling variability. Additional information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, sample design, and definitions may be found at <www.census.gov/retail/how_surveys_are_collected.html>.

Table 2. Estimated Change in Monthly Sales for Retail and Food Services, by Kind of Business

(Estimates are shown as percents and are based on data from the Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, Monthly Retail Trade Survey, and administrative records.)

NAICS code	Kind of Business	Percent Change ¹					
		Sep. 2024 Advance from --		Aug. 2024 Preliminary from --		Jul. 2024 through Sep. 2024 from --	
		Aug. 2024 (p)	Sep. 2023 (r)	Jul. 2024 (r)	Aug. 2023 (r)	Apr. 2024 through Jun. 2024	Jul. 2023 through Sep. 2023
	Retail & food services,						
	total	0.4	1.7	0.1	2.2	1.3	2.3
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts)	0.5	2.2	0.2	2.5	1.1	2.6
	Total (excl. gasoline stations)	0.6	2.8	0.2	2.9	1.6	2.9
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts & gasoline stations)	0.7	3.7	0.3	3.5	1.6	3.5
	Retail	0.3	1.4	0.0	1.9	1.3	2.1
441	Motor vehicle & parts dealers	0.0	-0.3	-0.4	0.7	1.9	0.7
4411, 4412	Auto & other motor veh. dealers ...	0.0	-0.6	-0.5	0.5	2.0	0.5
442	Furniture & home furn. stores	-1.4	-2.3	-0.4	-0.4	1.4	-1.1
443	Electronics & appliance stores	-3.3	-4.6	-1.7	0.7	-2.5	-0.2
444	Building material & garden eq. & supplies dealers.....	0.2	0.5	0.0	-0.1	1.8	0.2
445	Food & beverage stores.....	1.0	2.5	-0.5	1.6	1.0	2.3
4451	Grocery stores	1.0	2.5	-0.5	1.5	1.1	2.3
446	Health & personal care stores	1.1	4.6	0.6	3.4	3.6	4.3
447	Gasoline stations	-1.6	-10.7	-1.2	-6.5	-2.9	-5.6
448	Clothing & clothing accessories stores	1.5	3.5	-0.8	0.6	0.6	2.3
451	Sporting goods, hobby, musical instrument, & book stores	0.3	-3.5	0.1	-4.1	-0.5	-5.0
452	General merchandise stores.....	0.5	2.6	-0.4	2.0	0.8	2.4
4521	Department stores	0.4	-1.2	-1.0	-2.1	-0.5	-1.2
453	Miscellaneous store retailers	4.0	7.9	0.3	9.1	1.3	7.1
454	Nonstore retailers	0.4	7.1	1.6	8.1	2.6	7.0
722	Food services & drinking places	1.0	3.7	0.5	3.6	1.3	3.7

(p) Preliminary estimate (r) Revised estimate

(1) Estimates shown in this table are derived from adjusted estimates provided in Table 1 of this report.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, October 17, 2024. (Project No. P-7504206 / Approval CBDRB-FY25-0002),

Table 3 provides estimated measures of sampling variability. Additional information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, sample design, and definitions may be found at <www.census.gov/retail/how_surveys_are_collected.html>.

Table 3. Estimated Measures of Sampling Variability and Revision to Advance Estimates Sep. 2024

(Estimates are shown as percents and are based on data from the Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey and Monthly Retail Trade Survey)

NAICS Code	Kind of Business	Median CV ⁽¹⁾ for Current Mo. (%)	Median standard error ⁽¹⁾ for Percent change			Revision for month- to-month change ⁽²⁾	
			Previous Mo. to Current Mo.	Previous Qtr. to Current Qtr.	Current Mo. to same Mo. Last Yr.	Average revision	Median absolute revision
441 4411, 4412 442 443 444 445 4451 446 447 448 451 452 4521 453 454 722	Retail & food services,						
	total	0.9	0.3	0.1	0.3	0.0	0.2
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts)	1.1	0.2	0.2	0.3	0.0	0.1
	Total (excl. gasoline stations)	0.9	0.3	0.2	0.3	0.0	0.2
	Total (excl. motor vehicle & parts & gasoline stations)	1.2	0.2	0.2	0.4	0.0	0.1
	Retail, total	0.8	0.3	0.2	0.3	0.0	0.2
	Motor vehicle & parts dealers	1.6	0.8	0.4	1.0	0.0	0.4
	Auto & other motor veh. dealers	1.7	0.9	0.5	1.1	0.0	0.4
	Furniture & home furn. stores.....	2.9	1.8	0.8	1.9	0.4	1.2
	Electronics & appliance stores	2.1	0.8	0.5	1.1	-0.2	0.6
	Building material & garden eq. & supplies dealers.....	3.0	0.8	0.6	1.1	0.1	0.2
	Food & beverage stores.....	0.7	0.2	0.2	0.4	-0.1	0.1
	Grocery stores	0.8	0.1	0.2	0.4	-0.1	0.1
	Health & personal care stores	3.5	0.5	0.4	0.8	-0.1	0.3
	Gasoline stations	1.5	0.5	0.3	0.5	0.0	0.5
	Clothing & clothing accessories stores	3.1	0.8	0.6	1.1	0.0	0.3
	Sporting goods, hobby, musical instrument, & book stores	2.6	1.1	1.0	1.4	-0.2	0.4
	General merchandise stores.....	1.3	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.0	0.1
	Department stores	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.2
	Miscellaneous store retailers	5.0	2.6	1.4	2.9	0.6	1.4
	Nonstore retailers	2.1	0.5	0.4	0.8	0.0	0.3
	Food services & drinking places	3.4	0.8	0.5	1.2	0.0	0.2

(1) Estimated measures of sampling variability are based on estimates not adjusted for seasonal variation or holiday or trading day variation. Medians are based on estimates for the most recent 12 months.

(2) These columns provide measures of the difference between the advance-to-preliminary and preliminary-to-final estimates of month-to-month change for the same pair of months as measured by the Advance sample and MRTS sample. The average and median revisions are based on estimates for the most recent 12 months.

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, Advance Monthly Retail Trade Survey, October 17, 2024. (Project No. P-7504206 / Approval CBDRB-FY25-0002), Additional information on confidentiality protection, sampling error, nonsampling error, sample design, and definitions may be found at <www.census.gov/retail/how_surveys_are_collected.html>.